

Joe Chip

Class: Psychic

Origin: Human

Homeworld: Unknown

Level: 3

Background: Scholar

Languages: Mandate

Goal: I seek out natural-born psychics and teach them to resist corporate manipulation, believing that psychic power is a force of nature, not a tool for profit or war. I oppose any faction that weaponizes or exploits psionics, even if it means confronting former allies.

STR 11 +0

DEX 14 +1

CON 14 +1

INT 8 +0

WIS 12 +0

CHA 12 +0

HP 16

AC 18 vs TL3 weapons

AC 18 vs TL4+ melee weapons & firearms

Move 10m (Unencumbered)

Base Attack +1

System Strain max 14, permanent 0

Saving Throws:

Physical 12

Evasion 12

Mental 13

Psychic Refinement (level-0): +2

save versus any psionic power

Non-standard method: Attribute scores were assigned as desired.

Class Abilities: Psychic disciplines and techniques, plus possess an Effort score.

Skills: Know-0, Notice-0, Shoot-0, Talk-0

Foci: Psychic Training-2

Psychic Disciplines & Techniques: Metapsionics-1 (Psychic Refinement-1, Mindtracing-1), Telekinesis-2 (Telekinetic Manipulation-2, Telekinetic Armory-1, Telekinetic Expertise-2), Telepathy-0 (Telepathic Contact-0)

Effort: 5

Equipment

- **Readied:** Armored Vacc Suit, Backpack (TL 4), Laser Rifle, Telekinetic Armor
- **Stowed:** Binoculars (TL 3), Compad, Knife, Large Telekinetic Weapon, 2 x Lazarus Patch, Medium Telekinetic Weapon, Medkit, 8 x Power Cell (type A), Small Telekinetic Weapon, Survival Kit, Telekinetic Bolt, Trade Goods, Trade Metals
- **Cached:** -
- **Credits:** \$10

Readied Items: 4 (Unencumbered: up to 5, Light Enc: up to 7, Heavy Enc.: up to 9)

Stowed Items: 11 (Unencumbered: up to 11, Light Enc: up to 15, Heavy Enc.: up to 19)

Armor

- **AC 18 vs low-tech (TL3 or lower) weapons:** Readied Telekinetic Armor gives base AC 15; Dexterity gives +1 AC; Telekinesis skill level gives +2 AC
- **AC 18 vs high-tech (TL4 or higher) melee weapons and all firearms:** Readied Telekinetic Armor gives base AC 15; Dexterity gives +1 AC; Telekinesis skill level gives +2 AC

Ranged Weapons

- **Laser Rifle:** +3 to hit, 1d10+1 dmg, rng 300/500, mag 20, burst fire (uses 3 ammo, +5 to hit, 1d10+3 damage), ash or sand cloud applies up to a -4 to hit and halves range., TL 4, TL 4
- **Telekinetic Bolt:** +4 to hit, 1d10+3 dmg, rng 200/400, TL 4, TL 4

Melee Weapons

- **Knife:** +0 to hit, 1d4+1 dmg, Shock 2pts/AC15, TL 0, TL 0
- **Large Telekinetic Weapon:** +4 to hit, 1d10+2 dmg, Shock 3pts/AC15, TL 4, TL 4
- **Medium Telekinetic Weapon:** +4 to hit, 1d8+2 dmg, Shock 3pts/AC13, TL 4, TL 4

- **Small Telekinetic Weapon:** +4 to hit, 1d6+1 dmg, Shock 2pts/AC15, TL 4, TL 4
- **Unarmed Attack:** +0 to hit, 1d2+1 dmg, Unarmed attacks always add the attacker's Punch skill to damage rolls, unlike other weapons., TL 0, TL 0

Foci

- **Psychic Training:** You've had special training in a particular psychic discipline. You must be a Psychic or have taken the Partial Psychic class option as an Adventurer to pick this focus. In the latter case, you can only take training in the discipline you initially chose as a Partial Psychic. As with most foci, this focus can be taken only once.
 - **Level 1:** Gain any psychic skill as a bonus. If this improves it to level-1 proficiency, choose a free level-1 technique from that discipline (in Psychic Disciplines below). Your maximum Effort increases by one.
 - **Level 2:** When you advance a level, the bonus psychic skill you chose for the first level of the focus automatically gets one skill point put toward increasing it or purchasing a technique from it. You may save these points for later, if more are required to raise the skill or buy a particular technique. These points are awarded retroactively if you take this focus level later in the game.

Psychic Disciplines & Techniques

- **Metapsionics-1:** Master powers that nullify, boost, and shape the use of other psychic abilities.

Metapsionics is the rarest and most esoteric of the psychic disciplines, with few psychics having the necessary temperament or interest in developing these complex abilities. A metapsion controls psychic energy itself, molding and shaping the flows of energy that spill through the brains of those marked by MES.

Taken in isolation, metapsionics allows a psychic to increase the raw Effort available to them and become more flexible in how this Effort is used. Expert metapsions can even teach other potential psychics how to control and channel their new abilities, and the services of a trained psychic mentor command considerable sums in most systems.

Beyond this, in most stellar sectors a competent metapsion is the only practical way to protect a target from undetectable psychic assault. Without a vigilant brainguard, a head of state, interstellar celebrity, or planetary oligarch might find their minds rifled effortlessly by some undetected psychic intruder.

As a consequence, many metapsions become much more physically competent and better-trained in combat than the average psychic. The high prices they can command as brainguards attract some, though others find their clients too aggravating to endure for long.
- **Core Technique - Psychic Refinement:**

The metapsion gains improved mastery over their own powers and an innate sensitivity to the use of psionic abilities in their presence.

 - **Level-0:** The adept can visually and audibly detect the use of psychic powers. If both the source and target are visible to the metapsion, they can tell who's using the power, even if it's normally imperceptible. They gain a +2 bonus on any saving throw versus a psionic power.
 - **Level-1:** The metapsion's maximum Effort increases by an additional point.
- **Other Techniques:**
 - **Mindtracing-1:**

The metapsion can trace back the use of psionic powers they've noticed in their presence. By Committing Effort for the scene as an Instant action, they can see and hear through the senses of a user of a psychic power, gaining an intuitive awareness of their location and treating them as a visible target for purposes of their own abilities. Thus, if they see someone being affected by a telepathy power with no visible source, they can use this ability to briefly share the hidden telepath's senses. If used on a target that is teleporting, they can perceive the teleporter's view of their destination. Use on a metamorphically-shaped impostor would reveal the biopsion responsible for the change, and so forth. These shared senses last for only one round

and do not interfere with the adept's other actions.

- **Telekinesis-2:** Master the remote control of kinetic energy to move objects and fabricate force constructs.

Telekinetic abilities are something of a mixed blessing to those psychics who have them. While they are among the least feared and distrusted of psychic powers, they also produce effects that are not nearly so widely-demanded as biopsionic healing or metapsionic brainguarding. A telekinetic must be canny and creative to get the most from their abilities.

Telekinetic powers are strong but somewhat imprecise. The force they generate is usually invisible, though a psychic can allow a visible glow if desired, and the source of the telekinetic manipulation is not obvious to ordinary senses. Objects being held or worn by a mobile creature cannot normally be manipulated by telekinesis, nor can unwilling intelligent targets be directly manipulated. Machines, including non-sentient robots, can be affected as any other inanimate object, however. The psychic cannot use this discipline to lift their own person without special techniques.

Some techniques refer to a "physical attack" or "physical damage". This means a straightforward kinetic impact: bullets, punches, collisions, falls, compressions, or the like. Energy attacks are not included.

- **Core Technique - Telekinetic Manipulation:**

The adept may Commit Effort for the scene as a Main Action to direct telekinetic force toward an object or person within unaided visual range or with tactile contact with the psychic. This force isn't responsive enough to be effective as a weapon without further refinement of technique, and cannot cause damage to living or mobile targets. If used to crush or harm immobile unliving objects, it does 1d6 damage per skill level of the psychic per round of focus. Objects move at 20 meters per round when moved telekinetically.

A telekinetic force can be maintained over multiple rounds without expending further actions, such as holding a metal platform in place under a group of allies, but the psychic cannot again activate this technique on a second object until they release the first.

- **Level-0:** The psychic can exert force as if with one hand and their own strength.
- **Level-1:** The psychic can manipulate objects as if with both hands and can lift up to two hundred kilograms with this ability.
- **Level-2:** The psychic can lift or manipulate up to four hundred kilograms and smash a human-sized hole in structures of light wooden construction or lighter as a Main Action.

- **Other Techniques:**

- **Telekinetic Armory-1:**

The adept may Commit Effort as an On Turn action to create both weapons and armor out of telekinetic force. These weapons are treated as tech level 4 and act as a rifle or any advanced melee weapon. Attack rolls can use either Dexterity, Wisdom, or Constitution modifiers, and may use the Telekinesis skill as the combat skill.

Armor may be created as part of this power, granting the psychic a base Armor Class equal to 15 plus their Telekinesis skill level. This armor does not stack with conventional armor, but Dexterity or shields modify it as usual. The gear continues to exist as long as the psychic chooses to leave the Effort committed, and they may be invisible or visible at the psychic's discretion.

- **Telekinetic Expertise-2:**

The adept has become familiar enough with the manipulation of telekinetic force that they may now use Telekinetic Manipulation without Committing Effort.

- **Telepathy-0:** Master the reading and influencing of other sapient minds.

There is no psychic power more threatening and disturbing to normal humanity than that of telepathy. The prospect of having one's innermost thoughts and secrets pried out by imperceptible means is deeply troubling to most men and women, and telepaths are often given a wide berth by others simply for fear of what private thoughts they might sift out.

Some worlds that are otherwise accepting of psychic powers go so far as to ban known telepaths and forbid the teaching of the discipline within their territory. Even those few that do, however, can rarely resist the urge to

maintain some "government-approved" telepathic training program for candidates selected for their political trustworthiness or powerful backers. The benefits of having an imperceptible mental spy are too great for most states to forgo.

Most worlds do not ban telepaths. On these planets, the sheer rarity of psychic powers and the limited chance that any one individual might be unlawfully scanned outweigh any fear of unchecked telepathic intrusion. Telepathic testimony is almost never accepted in a court of law, however, outside of the most psychic-centered societies.

Almost all worlds forbid the uninvited use of telepathic powers on another person. The crime is very difficult to prove, but usually comes with harsh penalties. Open admission of an illicit scan is generally considered proof, so PC telepaths are advised to be discreet.

Telepathic shielding devices and substances do exist in very limited amounts. Even during the height of the Mandate, such resources were never abundant. Nowadays, only heads of state and similar elite personages might expect to shelter behind psionics-proof walls or have devices to alert them to telepathic tampering. Even then, many worlds will simply lack the pretech artifacts to erect such protection, even for their most important members.

Using and Detecting Telepathy:

Telepathy operates at a very basic level of mental contact, and is not impeded by a lack of shared languages. While the basic forms of telepathy only function on intelligent creatures, aliens or transhumans with human-like cognition can be affected. VIs, True AIs, and other non-biological intelligences are not normally subject to Telepathy techniques.

Telepathy is a subtle ability, and targets of its technique will not normally be aware of it. Only those with metapsionic expertise or Telepathy-0 skill or greater can tell when they've been targeted by Telepathy. Others may suspect this influence, particularly if they're aware of the existence of psychics and have just done something utterly inexplicable to their own reasoning. Certain extremely rare TL5 devices can also alert a target to the presence of telepathic tampering.

- **Core Technique - Telepathic Contact:**

The telepath can obtain a progressively-deeper understanding of a sentient target's thoughts. The target must be visible or otherwise perceptible to the telepath's unaided senses. Opening a contact requires the telepath to Commit Effort for the day as a Main Action, and the contact lasts for a scene at most unless augmented by other techniques

The depth of contact that can be made depends on the psychic's Telepathy skill. A single contact can use any or all of the effects permitted to a telepath of the user's skill level. Basic forms of contact do not allow for a saving throw, though more advanced probes allow the target to make a Mental saving throw to resist. On a successful save, no form of this technique that allows a save can be used on them for the rest of the scene.

- **Level-0:** Observe emotional states in a target. Intense emotions provide a single word or image related to the focus of the feelings.

Equipment Descriptions

- **Armored Vacc Suit:** An armored vacc suit has traded off some comfort and flexibility for additional protective thickness. Aside from functioning as a normal vacc suit, it has only half the usual chance to tear when hit by an edged weapon or suit ripper. The choice between armored or standard suits is a common debate in spacer bars. (enc. 2)
- **Backpack (TL 4):** TL4 versions of this item are effectively without encumbrance, albeit they cost 50 credits. A worn backpack counts as a readied item, though objects stowed inside it still require the usual round to dig free. Characters without backpacks or similar carrying devices might have difficulty justifying the hauling of large amounts of gear. (enc. 0)
- **Binoculars (TL 3):** Standard 7x50 binoculars. (enc. 1)
- **Compad:** One of a host of different hand-held portable communications devices. Most TL4 worlds have global comm coverage, but primitive worlds render these devices useless without a nearby comm server to provide

connectivity. (enc. -)

- **Knife:** Small weapons are small one-handed implements no larger than a baton or knife. These weapons are easily concealed in normal clothing, and can even be kept Readied up sleeves or in tailored pockets. Many can be thrown at a range up to 10 meters. (enc. 1)
- **Large Telekinetic Weapon:** A psychic that has mastered the Telekinetic Armory discipline can produce blades or blasts of pure psychic energy that act like TL4 advanced melee weapons. These attacks may use the character's Telekinesis skill as the combat skill when using this attack. Large weapons resemble two-handed implements of bodily ruin such as claymores, halberds, tetsubos, or other such weapons. (enc. 0)
- **Laser Rifle:** Laser rifles are among the most common type of energy weapon. Depending on the tech used in the sector, they might produce silent, invisible beams of death or noisy, brightly-colored streaks of lethal light. The phased multifrequency beam is capable of penetrating any ordinary mist or haze, but a thick cloud of thermally-resistant particulate matter such as ash or sand can seriously degrade the beam, applying up to a -4 penalty to hit and cutting ranges in half. (enc. 2)
- **Lazarus Patch:** A vital tool for adventurers, the Lazarus patch is a heavy compress laced with antibiotics, coagulants, system stabilizers, plasma, and a oneshot diagnostic suite. If the patch is applied to a character that has fallen to 0 hit points, the user can make an Int/Heal or Dex/Heal skill check against difficulty 6 to stabilize the subject. The more time between injury and application, the less chance the patch has to work. Each round after the first, an additional -1 penalty is applied to the skill check. The patch is no use after six rounds. If the medic fails the first skill check, they can keep trying the check once per round until the victim is revived or time runs out. Lazarus patches are no use on victims that have died of disease, poison, or have been mangled beyond surgical repair by Heavy weapons or similar trauma. Only one patch can be applied to a victim. Revived victims are critically wounded until sufficient medical help has been tendered; see the Systems chapter for details. (enc. 1 for 3)
- **Medium Telekinetic Weapon:** A psychic that has mastered the Telekinetic Armory discipline can produce blades or blasts of pure psychic energy that act like TL4 advanced melee weapons. These attacks may use the character's Telekinesis skill as the combat skill when using this attack. Medium weapons resemble one-handed swords, axes, spears, or other obvious implements of war. (enc. 0)
- **Medkit:** Containing a broad supply of pharmaceuticals, spray bandages, glue sutures, and a succinct handbook of injury care, the medkit is designed for handling sudden and drastic injuries. It also contains all the necessary tools for providing long-term recuperative care for critically injured characters. After each day of granting long-term recuperative care, roll 2d6 per patient treated; on a 12, the kit has run out of some vital pharmaceutical and has become useless. (enc. 2)
- **Power Cell, type A:** One of the few standardized artifacts inherited from before the Silence, power cells are small cylindrical objects designed to take and hold electrical charges. Type A cells are usually used for personal equipment, and the larger type B cells for vehicles and heavy gear. The engineering for the cells is substantially different, and they cannot be exchanged or recharge each other without a trained tech's modifications or a converter unit. Power cells can be recharged off a ship's power plant or other grid. Recharging requires 30 minutes for a type A cell. (enc. 1 for 3)
- **Small Telekinetic Weapon:** A psychic that has mastered the Telekinetic Armory discipline can produce blades or blasts of pure psychic energy that act like TL4 advanced melee weapons. These attacks may use the character's Telekinesis skill as the combat skill when using this attack. Small weapons resemble small one-handed implements no larger than a baton or knife. (enc. 0)
- **Survival Kit:** A standard belt-worn kit with fire lighter, water filter, three thermal flares, knife, thermal blanket, a brightly-colored 3 x 3 meter waterproof tarp, a glowbug, and a radio beacon that can transmit a distress signal up to fifty kilometers for one month on the included type A power cell. Survival kits sold on a particular world will usually also include a small booklet on specific dangers or edible organics. Possession of a survival kit grants a +1 to all relevant Survive skill checks, assuming its contents are helpful on a given planet. Survival kits are well-organized, and count as only one item for encumbrance purposes. (enc. 1)
- **Telekinetic Armor:** A psychic that has mastered the Telekinetic Armory discipline can create armor made of pure telekinetic force. This protective field has a an AC of 15 plus their Telekinesis skill. (enc. 0)

- **Telekinetic Bolt:** A psychic that has mastered the Telekinetic Armory discipline can produce bolts of telekinetic energy that have the impact and range of a rifle, and are treated as TL4 weapons. These attacks may use the character's Telekinesis skill as the combat skill when using this attack. (enc. 0)
- **Trade Goods:** Glowbugs, ceramic fire lighters, antibiotics, ceroplast tools, and the other fruits of a TL4 civilization that might be valuable on more primitive worlds. A kilo of trade goods can usually be traded for at least a hundred credits worth of local products on more primitive worlds that are not well-served by interstellar merchants. The profit margin shrinks rapidly as interstellar trade becomes more common, and there is always the difficulty of finding local products that are actually worth a merchant's journey. (enc. 1 for 3)
- **Trade Metals:** The fruit of common TL4 asteroid mining, trade metals include gold, platinum, artificial gemstones, and other substances precious on many lost worlds and trivially valuable on spacefaring ones. A kilo worth of trade metals can be exchanged for as much as a thousand credits worth of local products on metal-poor worlds isolated from interstellar trade. Markets flood rapidly, however, and it usually doesn't take more than a few merchant trips to persuade the locals to demand trade goods or credits. (enc. 1 for 3)
- **Unarmed Attack:** Unarmed attacks reflect ordinary kicks and punches. Unarmed attacks always add the attacker's Punch skill to damage rolls, unlike other weapons. Kinesis wraps, spiked knuckles, and other small fist weapons may be treated as small advanced or primitive weapons that use the Punch skill and add the skill level to their rolled damage, but not to Shock. Such weapons do not augment a hero with the Unarmed Combatant focus. (enc. 0)

Skills

- **Administer (Untrained):** Manage an organization, handle paperwork, analyze records, and keep an institution functioning on a daily basis. Roll it for bureaucratic expertise, organizational management, legal knowledge, dealing with government agencies, and understanding how institutions really work.
- **Connect (Untrained):** Find people who can be helpful to your purposes and get them to cooperate with you. Roll it to make useful connections with others, find people you know, know where to get illicit goods and services, and be familiar with foreign cultures and languages. You can use it in place of Talk for persuading people you find via this skill.
- **Exert (Untrained):** Apply trained speed, strength, or stamina in some feat of physical exertion. Roll it to run, jump, lift, swim, climb, throw, and so forth. You can use it as a combat skill when throwing things, though it doesn't qualify as a combat skill for other ends.
- **Fix (Untrained):** Create and repair devices both simple and complex. How complex will depend on your character's background; a lostworlder blacksmith is going to need some study time before he's ready to fix that broken fusion reactor, though he can do it eventually. Roll it to fix things, build things, and identify what something is supposed to do.
- **Heal (Untrained):** Employ medical and psychological treatment for the injured or disturbed. Roll it to cure diseases, stabilize the critically injured, treat psychological disorders, or diagnose illnesses.
- **Know (Level 0):** Know facts about academic or scientific fields. Roll it to understand planetary ecologies, remember relevant history, solve science mysteries, and know the basic facts about rare or esoteric topics.
- **Lead (Untrained):** Convince others to also do whatever it is you're trying to do. Talk might persuade them that following you is smart, but Lead can make them do it even when they think it's a bad idea. Roll it to lead troops in combat, convince others to follow you, or maintain morale and discipline.
- **Notice (Level 0):** Spot anomalies or interesting facts about your environment. Roll it for searching places, detecting ambushes, spotting things, and reading the emotional state of other people.
- **Perform (Untrained):** Exhibit some performative skill. Roll it to dance, sing, orate, act, or otherwise put on a convincing or emotionally moving performance.
- **Pilot (Untrained):** Use this skill to pilot vehicles or ride beasts. Roll it to fly spaceships, drive vehicles, ride animals, or tend to basic vehicle repair. This skill doesn't help you with things entirely outside the scope of your background or experience, though with some practice a PC can expand their expertise.
- **Program (Untrained):** Operating or hacking computing and communications hardware. Roll it to program or hack

computers, control computer-operated hardware, operate communications tech, or decrypt things.

- **Punch (Untrained):** Use Punch as a combat skill when fighting unarmed. If your PC means to make a habit of this rather than as a recourse of desperation, you should take the Unarmed Fighter focus described later.
- **Shoot (Level 0):** Use Shoot as a combat skill when using ranged weaponry, whether hurled rocks, bows, laser pistols, combat rifles, or ship's gunnery.
- **Sneak (Untrained):** Move without drawing notice. Roll it for stealth, disguise, infiltration, manual legerdemain, pickpocketing, and the defeat of security measures.
- **Stab (Untrained):** Use Stab as a combat skill when wielding melee weapons, whether primitive or complex.
- **Survive (Untrained):** Obtain the basics of food, water, and shelter in hostile environments, along with avoiding their natural perils. Roll it to handle animals, navigate difficult terrain, scrounge urban resources, make basic tools, and avoid wild beasts or gangs.
- **Talk (Level 0):** Convince other people of the facts you want them to believe. What they do with that conviction may not be completely predictable. Roll it to persuade, charm, or deceive others in conversation.
- **Trade (Untrained):** Find what you need on the market and sell what you have. Roll it to sell or buy things, figure out where to purchase hard-to-get or illicit goods, deal with customs agents, or run a business.
- **Work (Untrained):** This is a catch-all skill for professions not represented by other skills. Roll it to work at a particular profession, art, or trade.

Notes

Born in 3160 aboard a Star Map Drilling expedition, I was among the first generation of natural psychics after the Spike Drive revival in 3100. Detected as psionically gifted at an early age, I was taken from my family—whether through coercion or outright sale—and raised within a powerful Psionic Guild, a corporate-backed organization seeking to industrialize psychic labor. Trained under the strict doctrine of psionic mastery, I honed my talents in Metapsionics, not only developing my own abilities but eventually becoming a trainer for a new generation of AI enhanced and eugenically bred psychics. The Guild sought to create psionic super-soldiers and psitech-enabled servitors, trading these enhanced beings as high-value assets to the ruling elite of various systems. Through access to classified historical records, I learned the true nature of psychic exploitation—how psychics were commodified, enslaved, and weaponized across a millennium of interstellar conflict. Once comfortable in my privileged role, I came to see the system as nothing more than slavery, a perversion of what psionics should be. A critical turning point in my late 30s, the culling of my students, forced me to flee the Guild, knowing I would be hunted for what I knew. Now, a fugitive with invaluable knowledge of the psychic trade, AI experimentation, and hidden psitech secrets, I have found myself among a new crew, unsure of my place but driven by a newfound purpose.